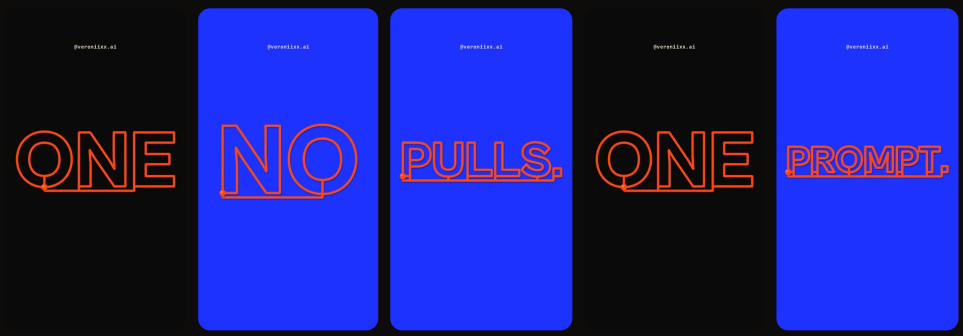
ONE LINE. NO CUTS.

How I made an 18-second showreel where one orange line writes every word, draws a spiral, ties a knot and comes back to the dot it started from. The words are the real outlines of the letters. It loops forever. No editing app. Windows and Mac.



WHAT YOU GET

A reel with one hero: a line. It is pulled from shape to shape on the beat of the music, and every word it writes is traced from the real font. The last frame is the first frame, so on Instagram it never ends. Claude writes the code, the shapes and even the music.

1	0	14	18s
LINE, THE ONLY HERO	CUTS	WORDS TRACED FROM A FONT	SEAMLESS LOOP

What you need

- A Windows 10/11 or macOS computer. No graphics card needed: this one is 2D.
- A Claude plan that includes Claude Code.
- A heavy font you are allowed to use. I used Cabinet Grotesk Extrabold from Fontshare.

WHY IT WORKS

01 · One hero
Only a line and a ball. Nothing else on screen, so the eye never leaves it

02 · Real letters
The words are traced from the font outlines, not typed on top. That is why it looks designed

03 · On the beat
Every pull lands on a beat and sounds like a plucked string. The music and the motion are one thing

04 · A perfect loop
The reel ends on the dot it started from. People watch it two or three times without noticing

The one trick behind it

Every shape, a word or a spiral, is turned into the same number of points: 1000. Then any shape can flow into any other, point by point. The ball is point number one, and the rest of the line follows a few frames late. That delay is what makes it feel like a real thread being pulled.

INSTALL THE TOOLS

1 Open a terminal

WINDOWS Press Win, type `PowerShell`, open it.

MAC Press Cmd + Space, type `Terminal`, open it.

2 Node.js, Git, Python and ffmpeg

WINDOWS Paste one line at a time. Answer `Y` when asked.

POWERSHELL

```
winget install -e --id OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS
winget install -e --id Git.Git
winget install -e --id Python.Python.3.13
winget install -e --id Gyan.FFmpeg
```

MAC Homebrew first, it will ask for your password. At the end it prints two lines under “Next steps”: run them, then run the second command.

TERMINAL · STEP 1

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/
install.sh)"
```

TERMINAL · STEP 2

```
brew install node git python ffmpeg
```

> **Important.** Close the terminal and open it again after installing, or it will not see the new programs.

3 Claude Code

```
TERMINAL

npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Prefer an app to a terminal? Install Claude from claude.ai/download, it has a Code tab that does the same thing.

FOLDER AND SETUP

1 Create a folder and start Claude

TERMINAL

```
mkdir one-line-reel\ncd one-line-reel\nclaude
```

2 Setup

PROMPT · SETUP

```
Set up a motion project in this folder.

1. Install Remotion (React 18 + TypeScript).
2. Check that Python works and install numpy and fontTools (with
brotli, so it can read .woff2 fonts).
3. Check that ffmpeg works from the terminal.
4. Put this font in public/fonts: [the font file, for example
Cabinet Grotesk Extrabold from fontshare.com]. Pick a heavy font
with clear outlines.
5. Build a test composition, 1080x1920, 30 fps: an orange dot on
a cream background. Render one frame to PNG and show me the
path.

If something is missing, install it yourself and tell me what
you installed.
```

THE REEL BRIEF

Words in square brackets are mine: put your own. Short words work best, one per beat.

PROMPT · REEL BRIEF

Make a vertical reel, 1080x1920, 30 fps, 18 seconds (540 frames), a seamless loop.
One hero only: an orange line (#FF4A17) with a small ball at its tip. The ball pulls the line and the tail follows a few frames behind, so you can see the line flow from shape to shape. No cuts, ever.

THE SHAPES (a Python script writes them to a JSON file)
- Words are the real outlines of the letters. Read the font with fontTools and flatten every letter outline into points.
- Stitch all the outlines of one word into ONE line, left to right. Between letters the line runs as a stitch under the word, never through a letter.
- Shapes: a dot, a straight line, the frame of the screen, a wave, a spiral, a circle, a trefoil knot.
- Resample every shape to the same number of points (1000), so any shape can flow into any other.

THE TIMELINE (120 BPM: one beat = 15 frames, the line moves on the beat)
dot → straight line (pluck) → [ONE] → [LINE.] → [NO] → [CUTS.] → the frame of the screen → [WRITES.] → wave → [PULLS.] → spiral → [TIES.] → straight line, pluck → the drop: [TYPE] / [MOTION] / [LIGHT] / [DEPTH], one every half beat → circle → [LOOPS.] → [ONE] → [PROMPT.] → knot → [BY CODE.] → back to the dot.
The last frame must be the same as the first frame.

MOTION
- The ball leads, the tail lags 3 frames behind. Add a small spring: the line overshoots the shape and settles, like a plucked string.
- When the line is straight, a pluck makes it vibrate as a standing wave that dies out.
- When a word is drawn, fill it softly.
- The background changes on the beat: cream #F1E8D6, ink #0E0C0B, electric blue #2133FF. The new color opens as a circle from the ball.
- My handle [@yourhandle] small at the top. Words stay between 220 px from the top and 380 px from the bottom (the Instagram interface).

SOUND (write it in numpy, no samples)
Plucked strings (Karplus-Strong), a deep kick, finger snaps and a sub bass, D minor, 120 BPM. Every pull of the line sounds like a plucked string. Loop the audio so the tails at the end flow into the start. Master to -14 LUFS, peak below -1 dBTP.

CHECK BEFORE YOU SAY DONE
1. Render a contact sheet of 40+ frames and a zoomed still of every word.
2. Check: the stitch never cuts through a letter, no word is cut off, nothing sits in the interface zones.
3. Compare frame 0 and frame 539: the loop must not jump.
4. Render the MP4 with sound. Tell me what you checked and what I should watch for in motion.

HOW TO FIX IT WITH NOTES

Watch the first render on your phone. Then send notes like these:

THE STITCH CUTS THE LETTERS

The lines between the letters cut through them. Run the stitch under the word, like a baseline, and only go up into each letter where it starts.

TOO SLOW

It feels slow. The line should arrive on the beat, not after it. Shorten the pulls and make the ball lead harder.

THE LOOP JUMPS

I can see a jump when the video loops. Make the last frame exactly the first frame, and loop the music tails too.

WORDS TOO SMALL

The words are too small on a phone. Make each word fill about 75% of the width, but keep it out of the top 220 px and bottom 380 px.

MORE DROP

The drop needs more energy: change the background on every half beat and add a short flash on the first word of the drop.

YOUR OWN WORDS

Replace the words with mine: [your 10 to 14 words]. Keep the same rhythm: one word per beat, short words on the drop.

WHAT BROKE FOR ME

- **The stitch cut the letters.** In the first version the line jumped from letter to letter straight through them. Running the stitch under the word, like a baseline, fixed it.
- **Claude cannot hear or see motion.** It checks still frames and numbers. Whether the pulls feel good on the beat is your job.
- **Check the loop seam.** If the first and last frames differ even a little, Instagram shows a jump every time it loops.
- **Use a font you are allowed to use.** Free fonts from Fontshare or Google Fonts are fine. Check the license for commercial work.

COMMON QUESTIONS

Can I use my own words?

Yes, that is the point. Keep them short: 2 to 7 letters work best. Long words get small on a phone.

Do I need to know code?

No. You need to know what you want to see and say it clearly. Claude writes the shapes, the motion and the music.

The terminal shows a red error. Now what?

Copy it and paste it to Claude with the words “here is the error, fix it and continue”.

BUILT YOURS? SHOW ME

Tag @veroniixx.ai and I will share it in stories.